

THE HAND BEGINS BEFORE THE COMMITTEE MEETS.

A constraint can be an escape hatch. Not “make bad work forever.”
Make the first move cheaper than the judgment attached to it.

BEGIN →

GOOD WRITER. BAD ILLUSTRATOR.

The phrase appears as a deliberate pairing in an early comics note.

[4] checked

The same archive's instruction was blunt: start and post. [1] checked

FORM: stick figures, graphs, short observations.
GRAMMAR: premise → setup → punchline.

FOLLOW THE MOVING HAND.

Lynda Barry describes children's drawings as emerging from hand movement rather than a settled intention. ^[5] checked

An eyebrow slips; surprise becomes anger; the story changes with it. ^[6] checked

PROMPT: Draw for ninety seconds. Do not erase. Let one mistake decide what happens next.



GENERATED ILLUSTRATION

Original generated study. The figures are not examples of Barry's or Shrigley's art and do not imitate either artist.

WORTH IS ASKED TOO EARLY.

Barry warns that worrying about value to others before the thing exists can immobilize the maker. ^[3]reported



COUNTER-MOVE: separate the making clock from the judging clock.

THE TEXT SHOULD NOT EXPLAIN THE PICTURE.

David Shrigley calls the gap between image and text “slippage”:
neither simply describes the other. ^[7] checked

The joke, or charge, lives in the voltage between them.

PROMPT: Caption a drawing with the least likely true sentence.

BUT STANDARDS ARE NOT THE ENEMY.

Research on perfectionism and creativity is mixed. One 2012 study found weak positive links for adaptive perfectionism on some measures, not a clean opposition. ^[2] checked

CORRECTION: roughness is useful when it opens discovery. It is not virtue by itself.

DELIBERATE AWKWARDNESS IS A FORM CONSTRAINT.

It can lower the cost of beginning, keep accidents available, and make the turn matter more than finish. [S] synthesis

SHIP
THE
MARK.